



CONFIDENTIAL SALES MATERIAL

Kastros HR — Sales Playbook

One secure platform for hiring, onboarding, daily HR operations, performance, compliance, and executive visibility — built for multi-location trading and corporate operations.

Document version: July 2026 · Platform: Kastros HR (Next.js 15 + Firebase)
Prepared for prospect evaluation and sales conversations

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Part A — Executive summary

Kastros HR is a modern, browser-based human resources platform designed for trading and corporate groups operating across multiple countries and business units. It replaces disconnected spreadsheets, email approvals, and folder-based personnel files with one secure system your employees actually use.

What your organisation gains: Faster hiring cycles, auditable leave and performance processes, executive visibility without manual reporting, and compliance artefacts (policies, Col, training) stored where auditors expect them.

Problems we solve

- **Fragmented employee data** — profiles, documents, and salary scattered across drives and inboxes.
- **Opaque leave tracking** — managers and HR lack a shared approval queue with balances.
- **Slow hiring** — applicants emailed as PDFs; duplicate data entry at hire.
- **Performance on paper** — annual review forms without phase control or scoring consistency.
- **Compliance gaps** — policy sign-offs not provably timestamped.
- **No executive dashboard** — leadership asks HR for headcount and pending items weekly.
- **Training ad hoc** — decks emailed; completion not tracked.
- **Weak audit trail** — cannot answer “who changed this record?”

Why Kastros HR — key differentiators

- **End-to-end lifecycle in one product** — public apply → onboard → operate → develop → comply; not five vendors.
- **Manager-as-reporting-line** — line managers approve leave and PMDF without a fourth login tier or per-manager licensing.
- **Multi-BU native** — UAE, Karachi, Multan with AED/PKR currency contexts built into profiles and compensation.
- **PMDF performance methodology embedded** — 80/20 scoring, phased lockdown, printable evaluations.
- **Public training manual (20 modules)** — adoption included; share links before go-live.
- **Enterprise-grade security posture** — Firebase Auth, JWT sessions, RBAC, CSP, audit log, authorised file downloads.
- **Cloud-ready on Vercel** — modern Next.js 15 stack; no on-prem server maintenance.

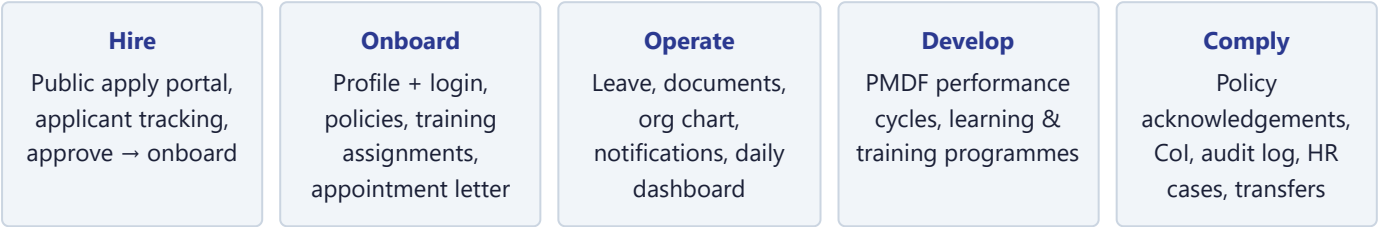
Who it is for

Organisation profile	Fit
Multi-location trading / corporate group (100–2,000 employees)	Ideal — BU structure, multi-currency, org chart from reporting lines
HR team seeking self-service + control	Strong — employees submit leave; HR governs policy and approvals
CEO needing operational pulse	Strong — dedicated dashboard tiles and probation alerts

Organisation profile	Fit
Regulated or audit-conscious employers	Strong — policy acks, Col, audit log, case management
Needs full payroll engine day one	Partial — compensation data captured; payroll UI on roadmap (schema ready)

Employee lifecycle flow

Kastros HR mirrors how people actually move through your organisation:



Each stage connects to the next without exporting CSVs or re-keying names and emails.

Value outcomes by stakeholder

Stakeholder	Before Kastros HR	After Kastros HR
Employee	Emails HR for leave balance; hunts for policies	Dashboard + My leave + Documents self-service
Line manager	Approves leave via email; no audit trail	Notification → approve in app; logged decision
HR team	Multiple spreadsheets; duplicate hire entry	Single people record; recruit→onboard prefill
CEO	Weekly status requests to HR	Live company pulse dashboard
IT	HR files on shared drives	RBAC, audit log, cloud-hosted with security headers

Open the conversation: “How long does it take from approved candidate to active employee with login and letter — and how many systems do you touch?” Kastros HR collapses that to one onboard flow with prefilled application data.

Part B — Platform trust & security

IT and procurement buyers need more than feature lists. Kastros HR is built on a mainstream cloud stack with defence-in-depth access controls suitable for HR data classification.

Cloud architecture

- **Application layer:** Next.js 15 (App Router) — server components and server actions for secure mutations.
- **Hosting:** Vercel or equivalent edge/cloud deployment with environment-based configuration.
- **Authentication:** Firebase Auth — work email + password; password reset flows.
- **Data persistence:** Firestore (production) with structured HR collections; demo JSON for sales environments.
- **File storage:** Firebase Storage for CVs, receipts, profile photos, policy PDFs, training decks, Col uploads.
- **Email:** SMTP integration for leave notifications and onboarding messages when configured.

Session & identity

- JWT session cookie (HTTP-only) issued after Firebase authentication.
- Custom claims carry role: employee, hr_admin, ceo.
- Middleware verifies session on every protected route; invalid/expired sessions redirect to login.
- Request headers propagate user email and role to server components for policy checks.

RBAC — three layers

1. **Route access** — middleware + route map deny modules by role (employees cannot open /employees).
2. **Server action policy** — mutations validate session role and ownership before writing.
3. **Row-level visibility** — e.g. leave requests visible to requester, their manager (when Pending Manager), and HR/exec.

File security

- Downloads authorised per artefact type — own files, manager scope, or HR-wide.
- Upload size limits tuned for cloud host (4MB on Vercel Hobby; 20MB elsewhere).
- Storage paths tied to employee, application, training, or document IDs — no open directory listing.

Audit log

Material mutations append to an append-only audit stream viewable in the Security module: onboarding, leave decisions, role changes, document registration, expense status changes, and more. Each entry records actor, description, and timestamp.

SMTP notifications

When SMTP environment variables are set, leave workflow sends parallel emails to managers, HR, and requesters — in addition to in-app notification bell items.

Security headers (production)

Header	Value / purpose
Strict-Transport-Security	max-age=63072000; includeSubDomains; preload
X-Frame-Options	DENY — clickjacking protection

Header	Value / purpose
X-Content-Type-Options	nosniff
Content-Security-Policy	Restricts scripts, frames, connect to self + Firebase/Google APIs
Referrer-Policy	strict-origin-when-cross-origin
Permissions-Policy	Disables camera, microphone, geolocation by default
poweredByHeader	Disabled — no Next.js fingerprint

IT buyer appendix

Question	Answer
Where is data hosted?	Firebase/Google Cloud region per project configuration; app on Vercel edge
SSO / SAML?	ROADMAP — email/password today via Firebase Auth
Backup & DR?	Firestore native replication; export via GCP backup policies
Pen test / SOC2?	Customer-specific programmes available during enterprise rollout
Data residency	Configurable Firebase project region at provisioning
API access	Server actions today; public REST API ROADMAP for integrations
Mobile	Responsive web today; native apps ROADMAP
Multi-tenant SaaS	Single-tenant deployment today; multi-tenant ROADMAP
Encryption in transit	TLS everywhere (HSTS enforced)
Encryption at rest	Firebase/Google Cloud default encryption

Part C — Roles & access model

Three login roles

Role	Typical users	Access scope
Employee	All staff	Own dashboard, leave, documents, training, own PMDF, org chart view. No people directory or admin setup.
HR Admin	People Operations	Full HR module set: people, onboarding, recruiting, settings, organization, letters, cases, leave HR queue, PMDF administration.
CEO	Executive leadership	HR Admin capabilities plus executive dashboard emphasis and User roles (Firebase role promotion).

Manager is not a fourth login

Important for prospects: Line managers do not receive a separate “Manager” product login or license. Manager powers derive from the *Reports to* email on each employee profile. Anyone with an Employee login who has direct reports automatically sees pending leave and PMDF actions for their team. This reduces cost and complexity versus traditional HRIS per-seat manager tiers.

- Leave: manager approves when status is Pending Manager and requester reports to them.
- PMDF: line manager completes manager phases for direct reports.
- Managers without reports use standard employee self-service only.

Module access matrix

Module	Employee	Manager (reporting line)	HR Admin	CEO
Dashboard	Own	Own	Ops tiles	Company pulse
My leave	Submit	Submit + approve team	Approve HR step	Approve HR step
People directory	—	—	Full	Full
Onboarding	—	—	Yes	Yes
Recruiting	—	—	Yes	Yes
Org chart	View	View	View	View
PMDF / Performance	Own form	Direct reports	All + config	All + config
Learning	Own	Own	Assign all	Assign all
Documents	Ack / Col	Ack / Col	Publish	Publish
Letters	—	—	Yes	Yes
Transfer / posting	—	—	Yes	Yes
HR cases	—	—	Yes	Yes
Organization / Settings	—	—	Yes	Yes

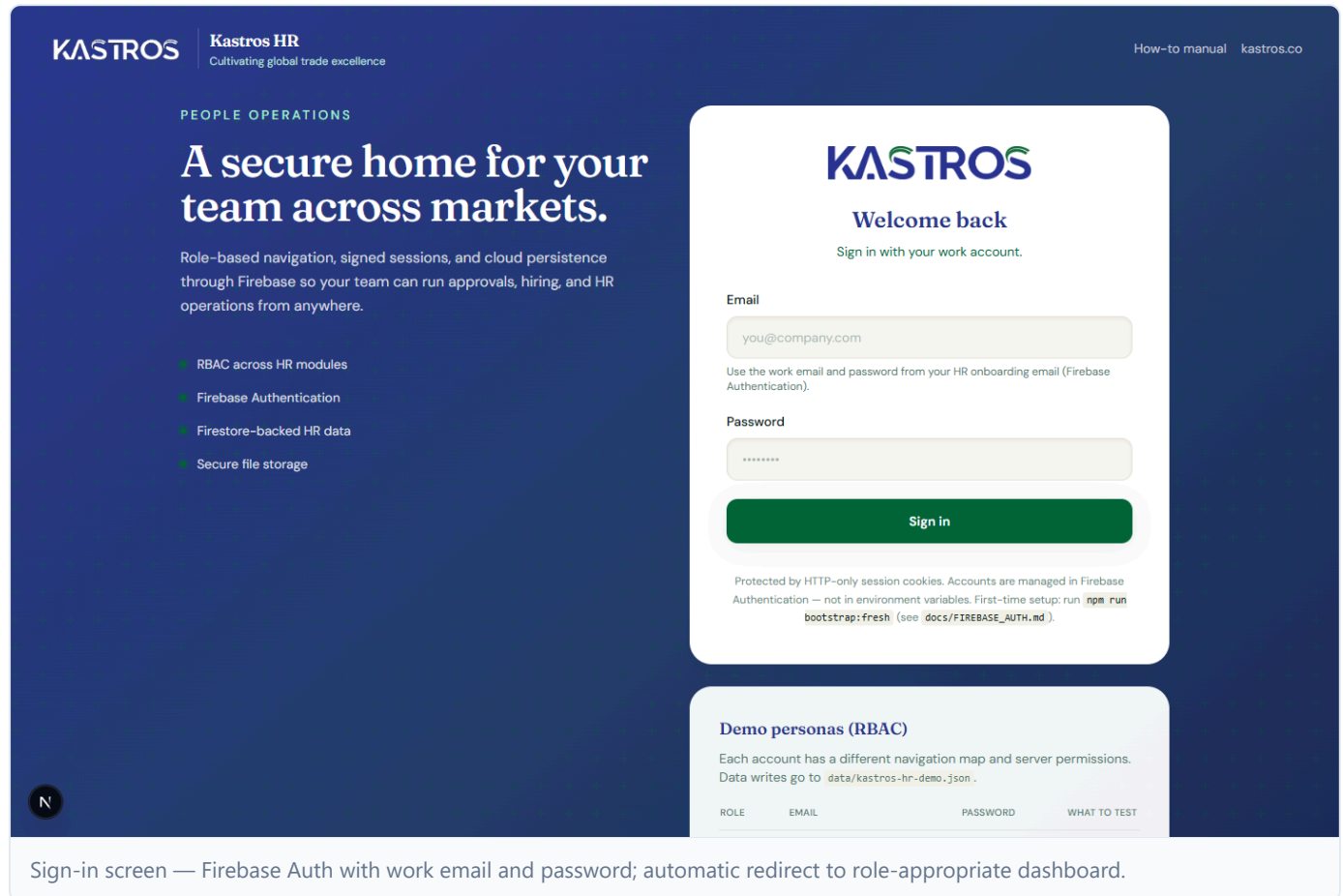
Module	Employee	Manager (reporting line)	HR Admin	CEO
User roles	—	—	—	Yes
Security / audit	—	—	View	View
Public apply / manual	Apply / read	Apply / read	Manage / read	Manage / read

Part D — Module deep dives

The following sections walk through each major capability with screenshots from the demonstration environment, role-specific benefits, workflows, and rollout guidance. Use these pages in order during a structured demo or leave-behind for economic buyers and HR leaders.

Secure sign-in

Give every employee a branded, work-email login — no shadow spreadsheets, no shared passwords.



Who benefits — by role

- **Employee:** Access personal dashboard, leave, documents, training, and org chart.
- **HR Admin:** Full operational modules after authentication.
- **CEO:** Executive dashboard plus HR capabilities and role management.

Typical workflow

1. HR creates the employee record during onboarding; Firebase account is provisioned.
2. Employee receives password reset / welcome email when SMTP is configured.
3. User signs in with work email; session cookie carries JWT with role claims.
4. Middleware routes authenticated users to dashboard; unauthenticated users to login.

Business value

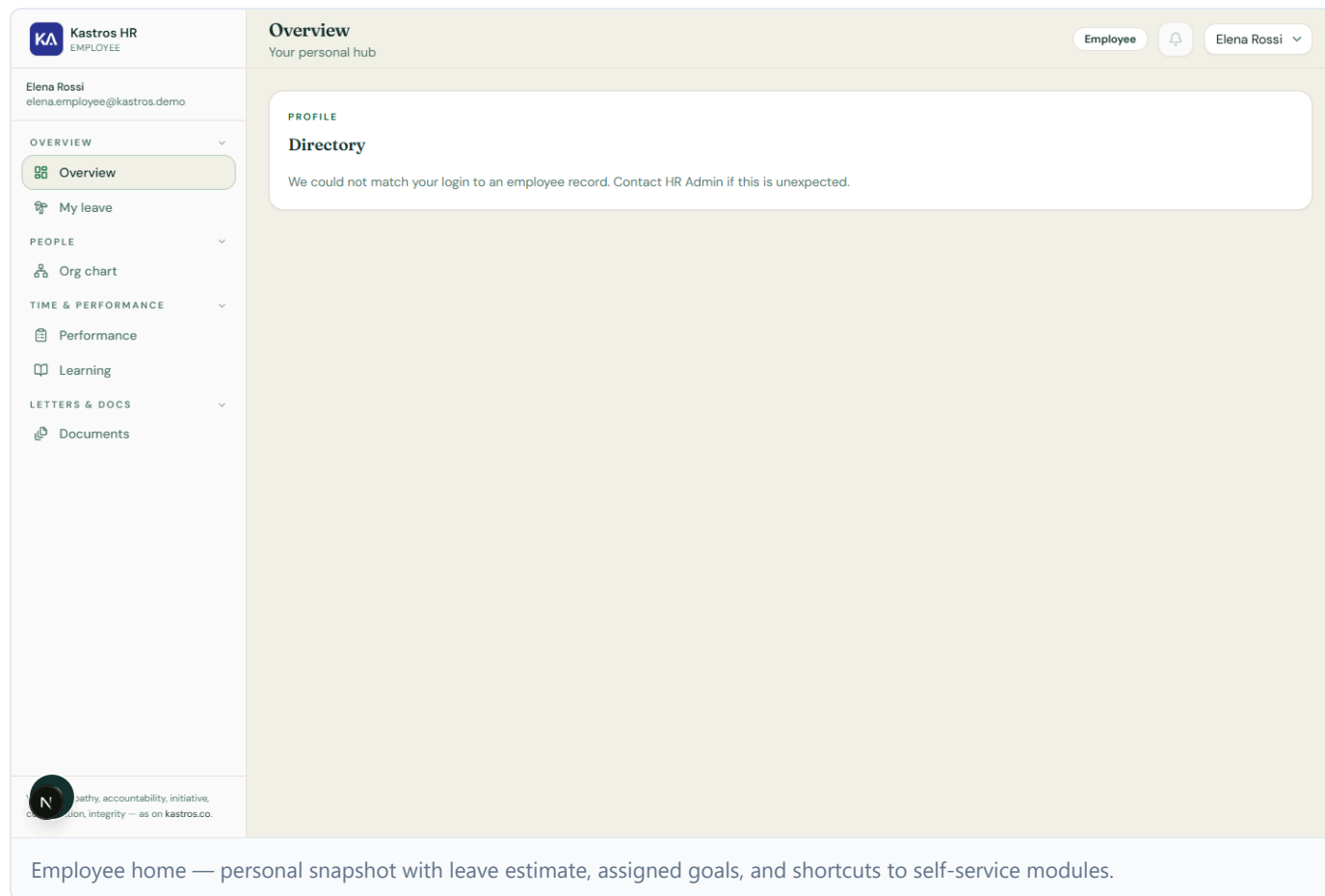
- Single front door reduces IT support burden and enforces consistent access policy.
- Password reset flows through Firebase — no manual credential sharing.
- Already-authenticated users skip login when returning to the app.

Configuration & rollout notes

- Configure Firebase project credentials and SMTP for onboarding emails.
- Map corporate email domain; each employee profile email must match login identity.
- Session cookies are HTTP-only; role changes take effect after re-login.

Employee dashboard

Employees see what matters today — profile summary, leave balance, goals, probation reminders, and quick links — without hunting through menus.



Who benefits — by role

- **Employee:** Primary landing page after login.
- **HR Admin / CEO:** Can preview employee experience when impersonation is not needed — use employee test account in demos.

Typical workflow

1. Employee logs in and lands on Overview.
2. Dashboard surfaces job title, department, manager, joining date, and probation countdown.
3. Estimated annual leave remaining helps plan time off before submitting requests.
4. Quick links route to My leave, Documents, Learning, and Help manual.

Business value

- Reduces HR inbox questions about balances and probation dates.
- Encourages self-service adoption from day one.
- Consistent layout across UAE, Karachi, and Multan locations.

Configuration & rollout notes

- Ensure leave entitlements are allocated for the calendar year so balance estimates are meaningful.
- Probation alerts appear when end date is within 10 days — verify joining and probation months on profile.

Executive dashboard

Leadership gets company pulse in one glance — headcount, pending leave, open jobs, new applicants, training backlog, and probation alerts.

Kastos HR
CEO

Hassan Malik
ceo@kastos.demo

Overview
Signed in as CEO · ceo@kastos.demo

Probation alert: 1 employee(s) are within 10 days of probation completion. HR should trigger confirmation actions — [open People](#).

EXECUTIVE VIEW

Company pulse
Whole-roster snapshot — same modules as HR Admin, with a broader dashboard lens.

ROSTER	LEAVE	TALENT	LEARNING
Active employees 21 0 on leave · 6 departments	Approval pipeline (company) 4 Requests in manager or HR review	Open jobs · new CVs 2 0 applications awaiting review	Assigned training (open) 0 Rows still marked required
PEOPLE	LEAVE	RECRUITING	CASES
Visible headcount 21 Full directory access.	Pending approvals (visible) 4 HR Admin or CEO: clear from Time off.	Open requisitions 2 Manage roles under Recruiting.	Active matters 0 Restricted HR cases.

ACCESS CONTROL

User roles
Assign Employee, HR Admin, or CEO access. Open **Setup** → **User roles** in the sidebar — changes apply after sign-out and sign-in.

CEO overview — company-wide KPI tiles and operational alerts for proactive decision-making.

Who benefits — by role

- **CEO:** Company pulse metrics and approval queues requiring executive attention.
- **HR Admin:** Similar operational tiles with team-focused counts (shared exec access pattern).

Typical workflow

1. CEO signs in and opens Overview.
2. Tiles show active headcount, employees on leave, department count, pending leave company-wide.
3. Recruiting tiles highlight open jobs and new applications.
4. Probation-ending-soon list prompts HR follow-up before confirmations.
5. Drill through to Leave, Recruiting, or People for action.

Business value

- Board-ready visibility without exporting from multiple systems.
- Surfaces bottlenecks (pending approvals, open requisitions) before they become crises.
- Aligns executive and HR on the same live numbers.

Configuration & rollout notes

- Maintain accurate employee status (Active, On leave, Offboarding, Separated) for headcount integrity.
- Use CEO role sparingly; role promotion is CEO-only in User roles module.

Leave management

Employees request time off in seconds; managers and HR approve with a clear two-step chain and full audit trail.

KA

Kastros HR

EMPLOYEE

Elena Rossi

elena.employee@kastros.demo

OVERVIEW

Overview

My leave

PEOPLE

Org chart

TIME & PERFORMANCE

Performance

Learning

LETTERS & DOCS

Documents

N

Time off

View balances, request leave, and (HR) manage per-employee entitlements. Configure leave types under Settings.

Employee Elena Rossi

My leave balances

TYPE	ALLOCATED	USED	REMAINING
Annual leave	25	0	25
Sick leave	10	0	10
Casual leave	5	0	5
Unpaid leave	0	0	0

Balances for calendar year 2026 (approved leave only).

Request time off

Leave type*

Select...

Start

dd/mm/yyyy

End

dd/mm/yyyy

Note (optional)

Submit request

Requests you can see

Signed in as elena.employee@kastros.demo. Flow: **Line manager** approves first, then **HR** gives final sign-off.

My leave — balances by type and year, request submission, and status tracking through approval stages.

Who benefits — by role

- **Employee:** View balances, submit requests with type, dates, and notes; track status.
- **Line manager:** Approve or deny direct reports' requests (no separate login — manager is a reporting-line relationship).
- **HR Admin / CEO:** Final HR approval after manager sign-off; cannot approve own leave.

Typical workflow

1. Employee submits leave request → status **Pending Manager**.
2. Line manager (from Reports to on employee profile) approves or denies.
3. On manager approval → status **Pending HR**; HR Admin or CEO gives final approval.
4. Employee receives in-app notification at each stage; optional SMTP email when configured.
5. Approved leave reflects in dashboards; denied requests retain history.

Business value

- Eliminates email chains and spreadsheet leave trackers.
- Manager-first approval respects operational coverage before HR payroll processing.

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- Per-employee entitlement overrides handle edge cases without changing global policy.

Configuration & rollout notes

- Define leave types and default days per year in Settings before go-live.
- Apply defaults to all employees for the calendar year; override individuals on Leave (HR view).
- Set Reports to (manager email) on every profile — required for manager approval routing.

Leave entitlements (HR)

HR controls policy at scale — bulk defaults plus per-employee adjustments — so balances stay accurate across business units.

KA

Kastros HR

HR ADMIN

Amelia Chen

amelia.hr@kastros.demo

OVERVIEW

Overview

My leave

PEOPLE

People

Onboarding

Recruiting

Transfer / Posting

Org chart

TIME & PERFORMANCE

Performance

Learning

LETTERS & DOCS

Letters

Documents

HR cases

SETUP

Organization setup

User roles

Security

Settings

Time off

View balances, request leave, and (HR) manage per-employee entitlements. Configure leave types under Settings.

HR Admin

Amelia Chen

My leave balances

TYPE	ALLOCATED	USED	REMAINING
Annual leave	25	0	25
Sick leave	10	0	10
Casual leave	5	0	5
Unpaid leave	0	0	0

Balances for calendar year 2026 (approved leave only).

HR ADMIN

Employee leave balances

Set how many days each person has per leave type for 2026. Values marked "custom" override the standard from Settings. Configure leave types and company defaults under [Settings → Leave policy](#).

Employee

HR Admin · Human Resources

Reset this employee to standard days

LEAVE TYPE	ALLOCATED	USED	REMAINING	EDIT DAYS		
Annual leave	CUSTOM	25	0	25	25	Save
Sick leave	CUSTOM	10	0	10	10	Save
Casual leave	CUSTOM	5	0	5	5	Save

HR leave administration — entitlement grid, approval queue, and per-employee balance overrides.

Who benefits — by role

- **HR Admin / CEO:** Configure and override entitlements; process Pending HR queue.
- **Employee:** Sees resulting balances on My leave (read-only).

Typical workflow

1. HR opens Leave module and reviews company-wide requests.
2. Filter or expand rows to adjust entitlement days per employee per leave type.
3. Apply policy defaults from Settings for new year or new hires.
4. Approve or deny requests in Pending HR status after manager approval.

Business value

- Central entitlement management prevents overbooking and compliance gaps.
- Supports different allocations for seniority, location, or contract type.
- Approval queue mirrors best-practice HRIS patterns (manager then HR).

Configuration & rollout notes

- Run Settings → leave types before first entitlement push.
- Document override rationale externally if required by policy; system stores balances and decisions.

People directory & profiles

One golden record per employee — identity, employment, compensation, education, documents, and manager linkage — searchable and always current.

KA

Kastros HR

HR ADMIN

Amelia Chen

amelia.hr@kastros.demo

OVERVIEW

Overview

My leave

PEOPLE

People

Onboarding

Recruiting

Transfer / Posting

Org chart

TIME & PERFORMANCE

Performance

Learning

LETTERS & DOCS

Letters

Documents

HR cases

SETUP

Organization setup

User roles

Security

Settings

People

Full directory control (HR Admin & CEO)

Data: Firebase Firestore

Saved to your cloud database (Firebase Firestore).

Select a name from the list to view full profile details, documents, and policy acknowledgements.

Find by name

e.g. Elena or rossi

Matches display name or work email (press Enter or Search).

21 in list

Search

Clear

Ahsan Mahmood

Chief Commercial Officer

Aliza Raees

Finance Executive

Asad Shabbir

Assistant Manager Origination & Execution

Bilal Chabra

Managing Director

Bilal Rashid

Senior Trader

Fahad Ahmed

Trader

Ghulam Hussain

Execution Executive (Cotton & Fibres)

HR Admin

HR Administrator

Khizer Mesiya

Ahsan Mahmood

ahsan.mahmood@kastros.co

Edit profile

Appointment letter

Corporate card

Active

IDENTITY

SalutationMr.

Full nameAhsan Mahmood

Work emailahsan.mahmood@kastros.co

Gender—

Date of birth—

Nationality—

Second nationality—

Marital status—

Religion—

Blood group—

CNIC—

CNIC expiry—

CNIC (front)—

CNIC (back)—

WORKING SCHEDULE & VEHICLE

Business unitUAE

Designation #—

Official #—

Duty hours—

Duty days—

Company vehicleNo

Vehicle #—

Driving licence #—

Licence expiry—

People directory — searchable roster with rich profile drill-down for HR operations.

Who benefits — by role

- **Employee:** No directory access; sees own data on dashboard and modules.
- **HR Admin / CEO:** Full search, inline edit, compensation, letters, ID card, document links.

Typical workflow

1. HR searches roster by name, department, or email.
2. Opens profile: identity, employment, statutory flags, manager, phones, emergency contact.
3. Edits inline; changes persist with audit logging.
4. Generates appointment letter, prints corporate ID card, manages salary and allowances.
5. Links personnel documents and records policy acknowledgements.

Business value

- Replaces fragmented folders and duplicate Excel master lists.
- CNIC expiry and probation alerts surface compliance risk early.
- Manager email on profile powers leave approval and live org chart.

Configuration & rollout notes

- Recommended hire order: top-down (leaders before reports) for correct org chart.
- Configure allowance catalog in Settings before entering compensation lines.

Onboarding

Convert an approved candidate or new hire into a live employee with Firebase login in one guided flow — minutes, not days.

The screenshot displays the Kastos HR Onboarding interface. The left sidebar shows the user 'Amelia Chen' and a navigation menu with categories: OVERVIEW, PEOPLE, TIME & PERFORMANCE, LETTERS & DOCS, and SETUP. The main content area is titled 'Onboarding' with the subtitle 'Add a new employee to the directory'. It features two primary forms:

- Quick add — C-level executive:** This form is for minimal roster entry for C-level roles. It includes fields for Salutation (Mr.), Full name (e.g. Ahmed Khan), Work email (ceo@kastos.co), Title (e.g. Chief Executive Officer), Location (Dubai), and Business unit (UAE). It also has a 'Reports to' dropdown set to 'None (top leadership)'. A checkbox for 'Create Firebase login and send password-reset email (recommended)' is checked. An 'Add executive' button is at the bottom.
- Add team member:** This form is for comprehensive intake. It includes an 'Identity' section with fields for Salutation, Full name, and Father's name. A 'Work email' field is also present.

A footer note states: 'Add team member — comprehensive intake form creating roster entry and authentication account.'

Who benefits — by role

- **HR Admin / CEO:** Create employees; optional Quick add executive for C-suite.
- **Employee:** Receives credentials after HR completes onboarding.

Typical workflow

1. HR opens Onboarding → Add team member (or follows Onboard link from approved applicant).
2. If from recruiting: approved application prefills name, email, phones, emergency contact, title, location, probation.
3. HR completes employment fields not on public form: department, BU, manager, joining date.
4. Submit creates employee record + Firebase user; audit log records event.
5. Trigger password reset email for first login.

Business value

- Recruit-to-hire continuity eliminates re-keying applicant data.
- Single flow reduces onboarding errors and missing manager assignments.
- Executive quick-add streamlines board-level appointments.

Configuration & rollout notes

- Approve candidate in Recruiting before Onboard prefill works.
- Education files from apply portal are not auto-copied — re-attach on profile if needed.
- Verify persistence mode (Firestore vs demo JSON) for production cutover.

Recruiting & applicant tracking

Publish roles, share public apply links, review CVs and attachments, and move approved candidates straight into onboarding.

The screenshot displays the Kastos HR Recruiting interface. On the left is a sidebar with navigation options: Overview, My leave, People, Onboarding, Recruiting (selected), Transfer / Posting, Org chart, Time & Performance, Letters & Docs, and Setup. The main content area is titled 'Recruiting' with the subtitle 'Open roles, applicant portal links, and submitted CVs'. It features a 'HIRING' section for creating a 'New requisition'. This section includes input fields for Title, Location, and Stage (with 'Applied' selected), and a rich text editor for the Description. A 'Create job' button is at the bottom of the form. Below the form is a 'RECRUITING Pipeline' table with columns: ROLE, LOCATION, STAGE, APPLICANTS, CANDIDATE PORTAL, LINKEDIN, and ACTIONS. A footer note states: 'Recruiting pipeline — job postings, applicant table, status decisions, and hire path to onboarding.'

Who benefits — by role

- **HR Admin / CEO:** Create jobs, review applications, approve/reject, launch onboard.
- **Candidate:** Applies via public portal (no login).

Typical workflow

1. HR creates job with title, description, location; copies public apply URL.
2. Candidates submit via /apply/[jobId] with CV and certificates.
3. HR expands application rows; reviews education, experience, cover letter.
4. Approve or reject; approved rows show Onboard action.
5. Onboard opens with prefilled intake from application.

Business value

- Professional careers experience without third-party ATS fees for core workflow.
- Attachments stored securely; HR-only access.
- LinkedIn job kit supports external posting collateral.

Configuration & rollout notes

- Define job descriptions in Organization setup for consistency.
- Share apply links on LinkedIn, careers page, or email — no candidate account required.

Public apply portal

Candidates apply from anywhere — mobile-friendly form, file uploads, no account friction — while HR controls what is collected publicly vs internally.

Trader

Karachi

Location: Karachi, Pakistan (Korangi Industrial Area)

Experience: Minimum 5+ years in physical commodity trading

Position Overview

Kastros is seeking an experienced, numbers-driven Senior Commodity Trader to spearhead our palm oil trading and procurement portfolio. In this role, you will manage end-to-end import cycles, optimize our local supply chain, and mitigate price risk in a highly volatile market.

Key Responsibilities

Trade Execution & Sourcing: Execute physical import contracts for palm oil products (Crude Palm Oil, etc.), managing relationships with major global suppliers and cargo networks.
Risk Management & Hedging: Monitor international futures (MDEK/Dansa Malaysia) and local market trends to execute hedging strategies and protect import margins.
System Management: Leverage commodity management software (Ika ERP platform) to log trades, track contract lifecycles, and monitor real-time exposure.
Regulatory & Logistics Compliance: Coordinate closely with logistics, customs clearance, and finance teams to ensure smooth vessel arrivals, prompt banking/LC documentation, and localized distribution.
Requirements & Qualifications
Experience: 5 to 8+ years of active experience in physical agricultural commodity trading (preference given to candidates with direct experience in edible oils/palm oil).
Market Knowledge: Deep understanding of global palm oil supply chain dynamics, freight/shipping logistics, and international trade finance (LCs, Incoterms).
Technical Skills: Hands-on experience using advanced CRM/ERP systems (Ika preferred).
Strong analytical and data-driven decision-making skills.
Network: Established relationships with international suppliers, local brokers, and industry players.

Candidate profile

Share your core contact details. Employment setup (department, business unit, manager, etc.) is completed by HR after approval.

Full name

Email

Phone

Education (optional)

Degree / qualification

Institution

Year

If you list one education field, list all three (degree, institution, year)

+ Add education row

Recruiting profile

Additional context for the hiring panel.

LinkedIn (optional)

https://

Current employer (optional)

Years of experience (optional)

e.g. 5 years

Salary expectations (optional)

Notice period (optional)

Cover letter (optional)

CV / résumé

PDF or Word (max 5MB)

Upload

Choose File

No file chosen

Submit application

Public careers form — candidate-facing application for a specific job posting.

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Who benefits — by role

- **Candidate:** Submit application, upload CV and certificates.
- **HR Admin:** Receives submission in Recruiting module.

Typical workflow

1. Candidate opens shared apply link for a specific job.
2. Completes contact, education rows, experience, cover letter, LinkedIn.
3. Uploads CV, education certificate, other certs.
4. Submission appears in Recruiting as Submitted; HR reviews asynchronously.

Business value

- Widens talent pool; no login barrier.
- Separates candidate-facing fields from internal employment setup (department, BU, manager).
- Reduces unqualified phone screens — full application visible upfront.

Configuration & rollout notes

- Employment setup fields intentionally excluded from public form — completed at onboarding.
- Ensure Firebase Storage / upload limits configured for certificate files.

Reporting channel (org chart)

Live org structure from manager relationships — no separate diagram tool to maintain.

KA Kastos HR
EMPLOYEE

Elena Rossi
elena.employee@kastos.demo

OVERVIEW

Overview

My leave

PEOPLE

Org chart

TIME & PERFORMANCE

Performance

Learning

LETTERS & DOCS

Documents

Organization chart

Reporting hierarchy built from each employee's Reports to field — top-down tree with direct reports nested below.

Employee Elena Rossi

Company chart My department

Full reporting hierarchy across the organization.

21 in tree 2 top-level roles

Multiple top-level roles are shown side by side. Set Reports to on each profile so everyone rolls up under one leader (e.g. Group CEO).

Drag to pan · scroll to zoom · click a card to open their profile

51% Fit Download

Reporting channel — hierarchical view derived from Reports to email on each employee profile.

Who benefits — by role

- **All authenticated users:** View reporting lines.
- **HR Admin:** Maintains accuracy via profile manager email and hire order.

Typical workflow

1. Each profile stores Reports to (manager work email).
2. Org chart renders tree from CEO / top nodes downward.
3. Transfer/posting or profile edit updates chart automatically.

Business value

- Always reflects current state — not a stale PowerPoint.
- Helps employees understand escalation paths.
- Supports reorgs without redeploying static charts.

Configuration & rollout notes

- Onboard managers before direct reports.
- Use consistent corporate email format for manager linkage.

Performance management (PMDF)

Run structured annual performance cycles with phased objectives, 80% business / 20% development weighting, and field lockdown by HR-controlled date windows.

KA

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HR ADMIN

Amelia Chen

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My leave

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Onboarding

Recruiting

Transfer / Posting

Org chart

TIME & PERFORMANCE

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LETTERS & DOCS

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1 Issue

Performance

Performance Management & Development Form (PMDF) — objectives, development goals, ratings, and feedback

HR Admin

Amelia Chen

HR — Performance cycles

Create cycles, distribute PMDF forms, and control when each stage opens and closes. Set open dates so managers can complete mid-year fields during the mid-year window and final evaluation fields during the year-end window. Lock the cycle when the period ends.

New cycle

Title

Start date

PMDF 2024-2025

dd/mm/yyyy

End date

dd/mm/yyyy

Objective setting (employee) — opens

Objective setting (employee) — closes

dd/mm/yyyy

dd/mm/yyyy

Objective setting (manager) — opens

Objective setting (manager) — closes

dd/mm/yyyy

dd/mm/yyyy

Mid year (employee) — opens

Mid year (employee) — closes

dd/mm/yyyy

dd/mm/yyyy

Mid year (manager) — opens

Mid year (manager) — closes

dd/mm/yyyy

dd/mm/yyyy

Year end (employee) — opens

Year end (employee) — closes

dd/mm/yyyy

dd/mm/yyyy

Year end (manager) — opens

Year end (manager) — closes

dd/mm/yyyy

dd/mm/yyyy

Create cycle

PMDF performance forms — business objectives, development pillars, phased reviews, and printable evaluation output.

Who benefits — by role

- **Employee:** Completes self-assessment sections when phase is open.
- **Line manager:** Reviews and scores direct reports (reporting-line access, not a fourth login role).
- **HR Admin / CEO:** Configures cycle date windows per phase; calibration and finalization.

Typical workflow

1. HR creates PMDF cycle and sets open/deadline dates for each phase (objective setting, mid-year, year-end, calibration, finalization).
2. Employee enters business objectives (must total 100% weight) and development objectives auto-distribute across five pillars.
3. Fields lock outside HR-defined windows — prevents out-of-phase edits.
4. Manager completes manager sections for direct reports when manager phase opens.
5. Scoring applies 80% business final rating + 20% development final rating for overall PMDP score.
6. Print/export formal evaluation for HR file.

Business value

- Embeds Kastros performance methodology (Empathy, Accountability, Initiative, Collaboration, Integrity).
- Phase governance ensures fair, time-boxed process.
- Rating bands link scores to HR actions (e.g. PIP eligibility).

Configuration & rollout notes

- Configure phase windows before opening cycle to employees.
- Assign line manager on profile before launching forms.
- Functional areas and location categories align to Dubai, Karachi, Multan offices.

Learning & training

Assign compliance and skills training with due dates, materials, and completion tracking — internal or external providers.

The screenshot shows the 'Learning' module for an employee named Elena Rossi. The interface has a sidebar on the left with navigation options: OVERVIEW (Overview, My leave), PEOPLE (Org chart), TIME & PERFORMANCE (Performance), **Learning** (selected), and LETTERS & DOCS (Documents). The main content area is titled 'Learning' with the subtitle 'Internal and external training, materials, and attendance'. It features two sections: 'Internal training' (Company-run sessions · mark who attended after each run. No sessions in this category yet.) and 'External training' (Third-party platforms and vendors (Udemy, Coursera, etc.). No sessions in this category yet.). The top right of the main area shows 'Employee', a bell icon, and 'Elena Rossi'. A footer note states: 'Learning module — assigned training rows with Required/Done status and downloadable materials.'

Who benefits — by role

- **Employee:** View assignments, open PDF/PPT materials, mark completion where permitted.
- **HR Admin / CEO:** Assign training to any employee; upload materials; track overdue items.

Typical workflow

1. HR creates training assignment: title, assignee, due date, provider, material upload.
2. Employee sees assignment on Learning page and dashboard alerts.
3. Employee completes programme; status moves to Done.
4. HR monitors open training count on executive dashboard.

Business value

- Audit-ready training register for compliance visits.
- Central materials — no emailing decks repeatedly.
- Supports onboarding curricula and annual refreshers.

Configuration & rollout notes

- Upload limits respect hosting platform (4MB on Vercel Hobby — plan accordingly for large decks).
- Use notifications to nudge overdue assignees.

Documents & compliance library

Policy acknowledgements, Conflict of Interest programme, and company library — with timestamped employee compliance records.

Kastos HR
EMPLOYEE

Documents
Company notices, shared library, policy acknowledgements, and Conflict of Interest

Employee | Elena Rossi

Elena Rossi
elena.employee@kastos.demo

OVERVIEW

- Overview
- My leave

PEOPLE

- Org chart

TIME & PERFORMANCE

- Performance
- Learning

LETTERS & DOCS

- Documents**

Company library
Company-wide notices and templates only. Personnel onboarding files live on **People**.

AI check
Notice / template · Omer · Internal · registered by admin@kastos.co
Preview Print Open

AI workshop
Notice / template · Yumman · Internal · registered by admin@kastos.co
Preview Print Open

Policy manual acknowledgement

HR Manual (v2026.1)
Printable copy: /policies/hr-manual-v2026.1.pdf
Preview Print Open Acknowledge

Code of Conduct (v2026.2)
Printable copy: /policies/code-of-conduct-v2026.2.pdf
Preview Print Open Acknowledge

Conflict of Interest declaration
HR uploads the Col template here. Every employee downloads it, signs it offline, then uploads their signed copy below.
No Col template uploaded yet. HR will add one above.

Documents — policy manual acknowledgements, Col submissions, and company-wide library access.

Who benefits — by role

- **Employee:** Acknowledge policies, download Col template, upload signed declaration.
- **HR Admin / CEO:** Publish policies, upload Col master, record acknowledgements on behalf of employees when needed.

Typical workflow

1. HR publishes policy versions to company library.
2. Employee acknowledges in-app; timestamp stored on profile.
3. Col: HR uploads template → employee signs offline → uploads signed copy.
4. HR reviews Col registry for completeness.

Business value

- Demonstrates compliance during audits without paper binders.
- Separation of company library vs personnel files on employee profile.
- Authorised download only — files linked to employee or document record.

Configuration & rollout notes

- Version policies when content changes; prompt re-acknowledgement.
- Personnel contracts and visas live on individual profiles, not mixed into library.

Letters & HR correspondence

Generate appointment letters from profile data, maintain letter repository, and print professional HR correspondence on demand.

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Letters
Generate and archive promotion, redesignation, trainee, and internship letters.

HR Admin | Amelia Chen

GENERATE

Issue letter

Letter type *
Promotion

Employee *
HR Admin - admin@kastos.co

Effective date *
01/07/2026

Issued date
26/07/2026

Effective date locked to 1st of the chosen month.
Promotion letters are forced to the 1st of the chosen month.

Current title
HR Administrator

New title *

Current department
Human Resources

New department
— Same as current —

Current salary (AED)

New salary (AED)

Notes / body

Issue letter

ARCHIVE

Issued letters

No letters issued yet
Promotion, redesignation, trainee, and internship letters appear here.

Letters module — HR letter repository and appointment letter generation from employee profile.

Who benefits — by role

- **HR Admin / CEO:** Create, store, and print letters.
- **Employee:** Receives printed/PDF output via HR (not self-service letter generation).

Typical workflow

1. HR opens employee profile → Generate appointment letter (pulls salary, title, BU, statutory flags).
2. Store executed letters in repository with type and date.
3. Print or save for employee file.

Business value

- Consistent branding and data accuracy from single employee record.
- Reduces Word template drift across locations.
- Supports promotion, termination, and custom letter types.

Configuration & rollout notes

- Enter compensation on profile before generating appointment letter.

- Configure Gratuity, EOBI, PF flags for locale-appropriate letter text.

Transfer & posting

Record cross-business unit and department moves with effective dates — history preserved for HR and audit.

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Transfer / Posting

Move employees across business units and departments.

HR Admin

Amelia Chen

MOBILITY

Request transfer

Employee *
Select...

Target business unit *
Select...

Target department *
Select...

Effective date *
dd/mm/yyyy

Till date (optional)
dd/mm/yyyy

Leave blank if permanent transfer.

Reason

Submit

WORKFLOW

Transfers

No transfer requests yet
Approved transfers update the employee's business unit and department.

Transfer/posting — document internal moves across UAE, Karachi, and Multan operations.

Who benefits — by role

- **HR Admin / CEO:** Create transfer records.
- **Employee:** Updated profile reflects new BU/department after HR action.

Typical workflow

1. HR initiates transfer: employee, from/to BU, department, effective date.
2. Profile updates; org chart and dashboards reflect new structure.
3. Audit log captures change.

Business value

- Supports multi-BU trading group operations (UAE AED, Pakistan PKR contexts).
- Clear paper trail for mobility and compensation reviews.

Configuration & rollout notes

- Maintain business unit master in Organization setup.
- Align currency on compensation when transferring across countries.

HR cases

Confidential case log for investigations and employee relations — restricted to HR and executive access.

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HR cases

Restricted: HR + CEO only (conflict of interest / conduct)

HR Admin

Amelia Chen

Open a case

Topic

Type

Conflict of Interest

Create

Matters

REF	TOPIC	OPENED	BY	TYPE	STATUS	UPDATE
-----	-------	--------	----	------	--------	--------

HR cases — secure log for sensitive employee relations and investigation matters.

Who benefits — by role

- **HR Admin / CEO:** Create and manage cases.
- **Employee:** No access — cases are restricted HR workspace.

Typical workflow

1. HR opens new case with summary, involved parties, status.
2. Updates notes as matter progresses.
3. Closes case when resolved; record retained for governance.

Business value

- Separates sensitive matters from general profile notes.
- Supports consistent ER process across locations.

Configuration & rollout notes

- Define internal protocol for case numbering and retention outside system if required by law.
- Limit CEO/HR role assignment to trusted users.

Organization setup

Master data foundation — business units, departments, sub-departments, and job descriptions — that every module depends on.

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Organization setup

Business units, departments, and job descriptions.

HR Admin

Amelia Chen

LOCATIONS

Business units

Set the **return address** for each sector — it prints on the back of corporate ID cards for employees in that business unit (if lost, return here).

Add business unit *

Select... Add unit

UAE

Corporate card — if found, return to:
Office address (card back)

Unit No: 75, DMCC Business Centre, Level No 6, Jewellery & Gemplex 2
Dubai, United Arab Emirates

Employees with business unit "UAE" see this on their ID card back.

Save address

Karachi

Corporate card — if found, return to:
Office address (card back)

4th floor, 59-C Lane no. 3, D.H.A., Al Murtaza Commercial Area, Phase 8 DHA
Karachi, Pakistan

Employees with business unit "Karachi" see this on their ID card back.

Save address

Multan

Corporate card — if found, return to:
Office address (card back)

e.g. Kastros Multan — building, street, city, phone

Save address

Organization setup — business units, departments, and job description library.

Who benefits — by role

- **HR Admin / CEO:** Full configuration.
- **Employee:** Sees assigned department/BU on profile and dashboard.

Typical workflow

1. HR defines business units (e.g. UAE, Karachi, Multan).
2. Creates departments and sub-departments.
3. Maintains job description catalog linked to postings and profiles.

Business value

- Clean dropdowns across onboarding, recruiting, and reporting.
- Enables location-aware policies and dashboards.

Configuration & rollout notes

- Complete organization master before bulk onboarding.
- Align BU list with legal entities for payroll handoff (future module).

Settings & policy catalog

Centralize leave types, default entitlements, and salary allowance catalog — HR changes policy once, applies everywhere.

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Settings

Company profile and dangerous operations (demo)

COMPANY

Kastros profile

Legal nameKastros

Default localeEnglish (UK)

Data residencyFirebase (Firestore)

SECRETS

Environment configuration

KASTROS_SESSION_SECRET — 32+ chars for JWT signing.

FIREBASE_* / NEXT_PUBLIC_FIREBASE_* — cloud auth, database, and file storage.

KASTROS_DEMO_USERS=true — local testing only; enables bundled demo accounts (not for production).

ACCESS

User roles

Assign Employee, HR Admin, or CEO access under Setup → User roles. The user must sign out and back in after a change.

HR ADMIN

Salary allowances

Define allowance labels used when setting each employee's salary on People. Choose Liters for fuel; all other types use a monetary amount.

Allowance name *UnitSort order

Cell phone allowanceMoney amount0

Add allowance type

ALLOWANCE	UNIT	ACTIONS
Fuel allowance	Liters	EditRemove
Cell phone allowance	Money	EditRemove

Settings — leave policy types, allowance catalog, and environment configuration.

Who benefits — by role

- **HR Admin / CEO:** Configure policies and catalogs.
- **Employee:** Experiences resulting leave types and sees compensation components on letters (not catalog edit).

Typical workflow

1. HR defines leave types and standard days per year.
2. Creates allowance types (housing, fuel, etc.).
3. Applies leave defaults to workforce for calendar year.
4. Per-employee overrides remain on Leave module.

Business value

- Policy changes propagate without code deployments.
- Allowance catalog standardizes compensation entries across BUs.

Configuration & rollout notes

- Settings first in 3-week implementation plan (see Part G).

- Demo reset available in non-production environments only.

User roles & access control

Three login roles — Employee, HR Admin, CEO — with route-level enforcement; CEO controls role elevation.

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User roles

Assign Employee, HR Admin, or CEO access. HR Admin has the same module access as the bootstrap admin account. Changes apply...

HR Admin

Amelia Chen

HR ADMIN · ACCESS CONTROL

Manage app roles

Each person must have signed in at least once so Firebase Auth knows their account. You cannot change your own role.

Employee *

Select an employee...

New role *

HR Admin

Full HR operations — payroll, people, cases, recruiting, letters.

Apply role change

Current roles (roster)

Live from Firebase Auth. "No login" means they have not signed in yet or were added without a Firebase account.

NAME	EMAIL	CURRENT ROLE	LOGIN
Ahsan Mahmood	ahsan.mahmood@kastros.co	CEO	Yes
Aliza Raees	aliza.raees@kastros.co	Employee	Yes
Asad Shabbir	asad.shabbir@kastros.co	Employee	Yes
Bilal Chabra	bilal.chabra@kastros.co	CEO	Yes
Bilal Rashid	bilal.rashid@kastros.co	Employee	Yes
Fahad Ahmed	fahad.ahmed@kastros.co	Employee	Yes
Ghulam Hussain	ghulam.hussain@kastros.co	Employee	Yes
HR Admin	admin@kastros.co	HR Admin	Yes
Khizer Mesiya	khizer.mesiya@kastros.co	CEO	Yes
Khuwaja Muhammad Suleman	khawaja.suleman@kastros.co	Employee	Yes

User roles — Firebase role assignment with CEO-only promotion to HR Admin or CEO.

Who benefits — by role

- **CEO:** Promote/demote Employee ↔ HR Admin ↔ CEO.
- **HR Admin:** Cannot self-elevate; operational access only.
- **Employee:** Self-service scope only.

Typical workflow

1. CEO opens User roles, searches by email.
2. Assigns role; Firebase custom claims update.
3. User re-logs in for new permissions to take effect.

Business value

- Prevents privilege creep — only CEO can create HR Admins.
- Clear separation between employee self-service and HR operations.

Configuration & rollout notes

- Minimize CEO role count; use HR Admin for daily operations.

- Managers are not a login role — they act via reporting line on leave and PMDF.

Security & audit log

Demonstrate accountability — chronological audit of material HR actions for compliance spot-checks and investigations.

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Security

Live audit trail from demo mutations + platform posture

POSTURE

Platform controls

- HTTP-only, SameSite=Strict session cookie (signed JWT)
- RBAC enforced in middleware + server actions
- Security headers (HSTS, CSP, XFO DENY, nosniff)
- Add MFA / SSO at your gateway for production

AUDIT TRAIL

Recent events

TIMESTAMP (UTC)	ACTOR	ACTION
2026-07-26T11:16:20.499Z	muhammad.farhan@kastros.co	Requested leave (Sick leave)
2026-07-22T11:52:45.577Z	tanveer.ahmed@kastros.co	Requested leave (Casual leave)
2026-07-22T10:16:35.141Z	yusra.rizwan@kastros.co	Assigned PMDF (organisation) to 21 employee(s)
2026-07-22T10:15:35.302Z	yusra.rizwan@kastros.co	Created performance cycle Performance Management & Development Objectives, 2026-2027
2026-07-21T13:36:47.345Z	yusra.rizwan@kastros.co	Deleted performance cycle "PMDf-2026-2027" (1 form(s))
2026-07-21T11:05:56.513Z	yusra.rizwan@kastros.co	Sent password reset email to sami.qasim@kastros.co
2026-07-20T10:25:03.146Z	yusra.rizwan@kastros.co	Set Casual leave for khizer.mesiya@kastros.co (2026): 8 days
2026-07-20T10:16:42.136Z	yusra.rizwan@kastros.co	Sent password reset email to bilal.rashid@kastros.co
2026-07-20T10:14:38.976Z	yusra.rizwan@kastros.co	Sent password reset email to faraz.syed@kastros.co
2026-07-20T09:58:55.242Z	yusra.rizwan@kastros.co	Set Casual leave for bilal.rashid@kastros.co (2026): 8 days
2026-07-20T09:58:43.532Z	yusra.rizwan@kastros.co	Set Casual leave for khawaja.suleman@kastros.co (2026): 8 days
2026-07-20T09:58:43.532Z	yusra.rizwan@kastros.co	Set Casual leave for muhammad.farhan@kastros.co (2026): 8 days

Security module — audit log viewer with actor, action, and timestamp.

Who benefits — by role

- **HR Admin / CEO:** View audit log.
- **Employee:** No access.

Typical workflow

1. HR opens Security → Audit log.
2. Filter chronologically; review onboarding, leave decisions, role changes, document events.
3. Export or screenshot for audit pack as needed.

Business value

- Supports ISO-style accountability questions.
- Complements Firebase Auth logs for defence in depth.

Configuration & rollout notes

- Review audit log monthly as HR control.
- Retention follows Firestore backup policy in production.

In-app notifications

Keep managers and HR on top of approvals, recruiting, training, and compliance — without email overload.

The screenshot displays the Kastros HR HR Admin interface. On the left is a sidebar with navigation links: Overview, My leave, People, Onboarding, Recruiting, Transfer / Posting, Org chart, Performance, Learning, Letters, Documents, HR cases, Organization setup, User roles, Security, and Settings. The main content area is titled 'Overview' and shows a 'Signed in as HR Admin · amelia.hr@kastros.demo' status. A yellow banner at the top reads: 'Probation alert: 1 employee(s) are within 10 days of probation completion. HR should trigger conf...'. Below this are four cards: 'Visible headcount' (21), 'Pending approvals (visible)' (4), 'Open' (2), and 'Restricted HR cases' (0). A 'Notifications' dropdown menu is open, showing 'Loading notifications...'. Below the cards is an 'ACCESS CONTROL' section for 'User roles' and an 'ORGANIZATION OVERVIEW' section with 'Our Story' text. At the bottom, a blue bar states: 'Notification bell — aggregated alerts for leave approvals, new applicants, training due, and policy items.'

Who benefits — by role

- **All roles:** See notifications permitted for their route access.
- **Line manager:** Leave pending manager approval for direct reports.
- **HR Admin:** Pending HR leave, new applicants, approved-ready-to-hire, training overdue.

Typical workflow

1. System derives notifications from live store state on each page load.
2. User opens bell icon; clicks through to relevant module.
3. Parallel SMTP emails sent for leave events when mail is configured.

Business value

- Reduces missed approvals that delay payroll and coverage planning.
- Single inbox inside the HR platform users already open daily.

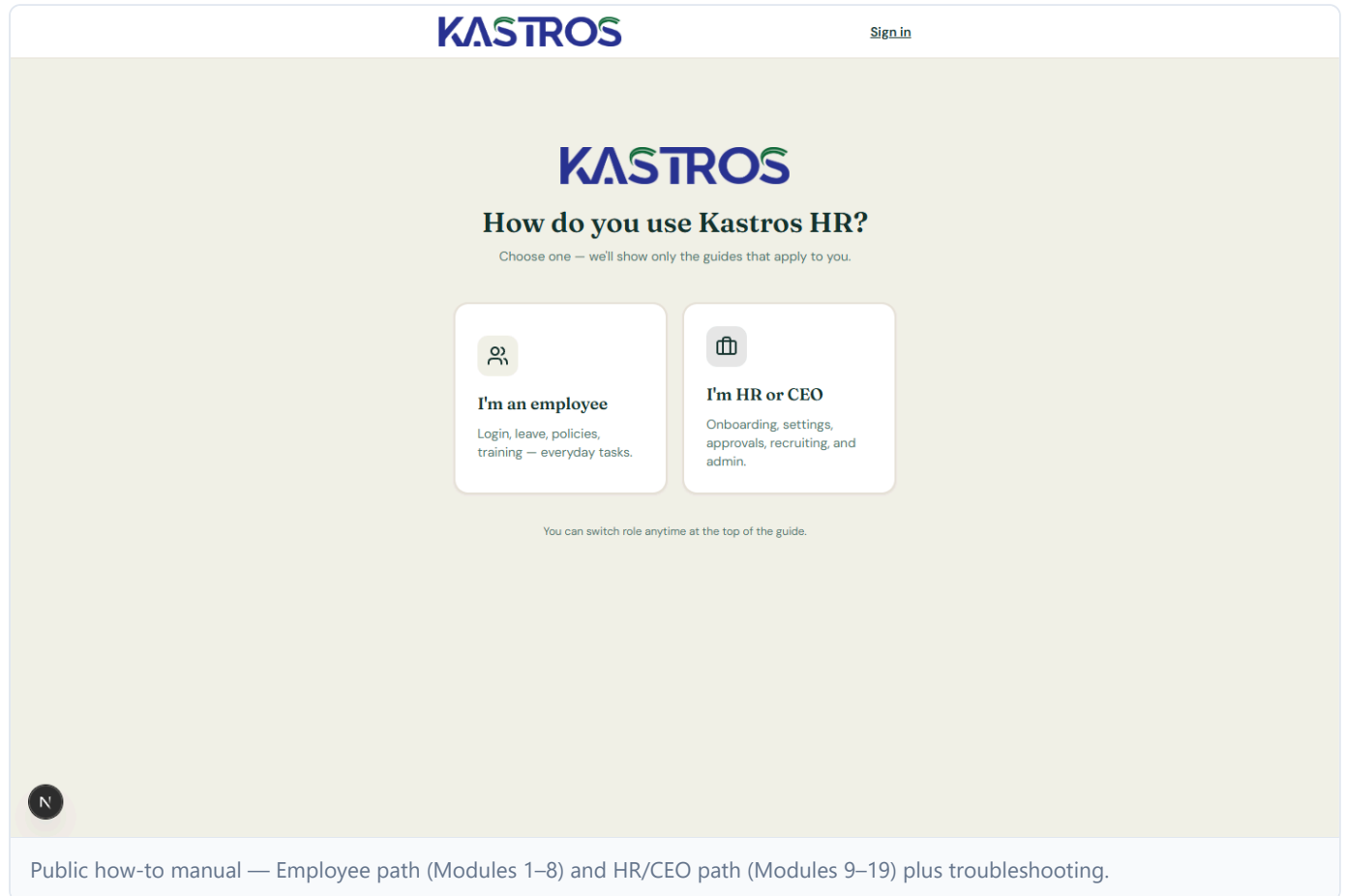
Configuration & rollout notes

- Configure SMTP for email parity with in-app alerts.

- Ensure manager emails correct for leave routing.

Public training manual

20 progressive modules — shareable without login — so employees and HR adopt the platform faster with searchable how-to guidance.



Who benefits — by role

- **Employee:** Modules 1–8 — login, navigation, leave, documents, learning, org chart.
- **HR Admin / CEO:** Modules 9–19 — setup, onboarding, people, leave ops, recruiting, letters, security.
- **All:** Module 20 troubleshooting; search any keyword (e.g. probation, Pending HR).

Typical workflow

1. Share /training-manual/how-to link in welcome email.
2. Use ?role=employee or ?role=hr query for targeted comms.
3. In-app ? button opens manual in new tab during work.

Business value

- Cuts training cost — no separate LMS required for system adoption.
- Always matches shipped product (same source as in-app help).
- Prospects can review help content before purchase.

Configuration & rollout notes

- Expenses modules hidden in manual when KASTROS_EXPENSES_ENABLED is false.
- No authentication required — suitable for intranet and email links.

Part E — Cross-cutting capabilities

Notification types

In-app notifications aggregate actionable items by kind:

Kind	Examples	Typical recipient
approval	Leave pending manager / HR; your leave awaiting approval	Manager, HR, employee
recruiting	New applicant submitted; approved candidate ready to onboard	HR Admin, CEO
learning	Training overdue or due soon	Assignee, HR
policy	Policy acknowledgement pending	Employee, HR
people	Probation ending soon; CNIC expiry approaching	HR Admin, CEO
team	Team-scoped operational hints	Managers, HR
compliance	Col or document compliance gaps	HR Admin
payroll	Reserved for future payroll workflow hooks	HR Admin

Appointment letter generation

From any employee profile, HR generates a formatted appointment letter pulling live data: name, title, department, business unit, joining date, probation, gross salary, statutory flags (Gratuity, EOBI, Provident Fund). Eliminates copy-paste errors from Word templates and ensures compensation on file matches the letter issued.

Corporate ID card

Print-ready corporate ID card from profile photo, employee ID, name, title, and department — standardised branding for UAE and Pakistan offices. Reduces dependency on external print vendors for routine new-hire badges.

LinkedIn job kit

Recruiting module supports collateral for external job posts (LinkedIn and careers pages) so HR markets openings consistently with internal job records and public apply links.

Multi-business unit operations

Native support for Kastros Group locations:

- **UAE** — AED default currency context; Dubai office category in PMDF.
- **Karachi** — PKR context; Karachi office category.
- **Multan** — PKR context; Multan office category.

Transfer/posting module records moves between BUs with effective dates; compensation currency editable per profile.

Multi-currency compensation

Profiles store salary in AED, PKR, or USD with configurable allowance lines from the Settings catalog. Display formatting uses thousands separators for executive readability. Prepares for payroll integration without re-entry.

Public training manual — 20 modules

Shipped as part of the product — not an extra consulting deliverable:

1. Getting started
2. Roles & navigation
3. Employee daily workflow
4. Leave (employee)
5. Expenses (when enabled)
6. Documents
7. Learning & performance view
8. Org chart
9. HR setup overview
10. HR settings
11. HR organization
12. HR onboarding
13. HR people / profiles
14. HR leave operations
15. HR expense operations
16. HR documents
17. HR recruiting
18. HR letters, transfer, cases
19. HR CEO & security
20. Troubleshooting

Search supports keywords like *probation*, *allowance*, *Pending HR*. Share before go-live to accelerate adoption.

Part F — Product roadmap

Kastros HR is production-ready for core HR operations today. The following items extend the platform for prospects with advanced requirements:

Capability	Status	Notes
Core HR (leave, people, recruiting, PMDF, docs, training)	LIVE	Demonstrated in this playbook
Expense claims	FEATURE-FLAGGED	Set KASTROS_EXPENSES_ENABLED=true in environment; hidden by default
Payroll UI	ROADMAP	Compensation schema ready on profiles; payroll processing UI planned
Mobile-native apps	ROADMAP	Responsive web today; iOS/Android clients planned
SSO / SAML	ROADMAP	Enterprise IdP integration (Azure AD, Okta) on Firebase/custom token path
Multi-tenant SaaS	ROADMAP	Single-tenant per customer today; shared SaaS for SMB segment planned

Sales talk track: Lead with live modules. Position expense claims as flip-a-switch for prospects needing T&E now. Position payroll as natural phase 2 — data model already captures gross, basic, and allowances. SSO and multi-tenant address enterprise procurement checklists without blocking mid-market deals today.

Part G — Implementation, demo & next steps

Feature matrix (summary)

Capability	Employee	HR Admin	CEO
Dashboard	Own	Ops	Pulse
Leave	Request	Entitlements + HR approve	HR approve
People / profiles	—	Full	Full
Onboarding + auth	—	Yes	Yes
Recruiting + apply portal	Apply	Full	Full
PMDf performance	Own	Configure + all	Configure + all
Learning	Own	Assign	Assign
Documents / Col	Submit	Manage	Manage
Letters / ID card	—	Yes	Yes
Transfer / cases	—	Yes	Yes
Org / settings	—	Yes	Yes
Audit log	—	View	View
User roles	—	—	Yes
Training manual (public)	Read	Read	Read
Expense claims	If enabled	If enabled	If enabled

Three-week implementation phases

Week	Focus	Deliverables
Week 1 — Foundation	Organization setup, Settings (leave types, allowances), Firebase project, SMTP, role assignments	BU/department master, policy catalog, CEO + HR admin accounts, training manual shared
Week 2 — People	Top-down onboarding, manager linkages, leave entitlements, document library, policy publish	Active roster live, org chart verified, employees logging in
Week 3 — Operations	Recruiting live, PMDF cycle prep, training assignments, executive dashboard review, hypercare	First leave approvals end-to-end, hire-from-apply tested, go-live sign-off

15-minute demo script

- 0:00–1:30 — Hook:** CEO dashboard — headcount, pending leave, open jobs (screenshot: dashboard-ceo).
- 1:30–3:30 — Employee story:** Login → employee dashboard → submit leave (login, dashboard-employee, leave).

3. **3:30–5:30 — Manager + HR approval:** Explain reporting-line manager approval → HR final on leave-hr-entitlements.
4. **5:30–8:00 — Hire flow:** Public apply → recruiting approve → onboard prefill (apply-portal, recruiting, onboarding).
5. **8:00–10:30 — People & compliance:** Profile, appointment letter, documents/Col (employees, letters, documents).
6. **10:30–12:30 — Develop:** PMDF 80/20 and phase windows (performance); assign training (training).
7. **12:30–14:00 — Trust:** Audit log, roles, notifications (security, user-roles, notifications).
8. **14:00–15:00 — Close:** Training manual link, 3-week rollout, roadmap honesty, next steps.

Next steps

[Prospect name] — proposed actions following this briefing:

- Schedule live demo with prospect's org structure (optional: import sample BU/dept list).
- Confirm user count and locations for commercial proposal.
- Identify integration requirements (SSO, payroll vendor, expense policy).
- Agree implementation start date and executive sponsor.
- Provide demonstration environment credentials or dedicated trial tenant.

Contact: _____ · Date: _____

Appendix — Buyer personas & discovery

Who you are selling to

Persona	Primary pain	Kastros HR message	Modules to demo
CEO / MD	No real-time people metrics	Company pulse dashboard, probation alerts, audit accountability	dashboard-ceo, security, notifications
HR Director	Tool sprawl, manual hire data entry	Single platform recruit→onboard→operate; entitlement control	recruiting, onboarding, leave-hr-entitlements, employees
IT / Security	Shadow HR files, access risk	Firebase Auth, RBAC, CSP, audit log, authorised downloads	Part B, security, user-roles
Line managers	Email leave approvals	Approve in-app as reporting-line manager — no extra license	leave, notifications
Employees	Unclear balances and policies	Self-service dashboard, public training manual	dashboard-employee, training-manual, documents
Finance / CFO	Compensation data scattered	Structured salary + allowances; appointment letters; payroll-ready schema	employees, letters, settings, roadmap payroll

Discovery questions (use in first call)

1. How many employees and in which countries/BUs do you operate today?
2. How do managers approve leave today — email, paper, or another system?
3. Where do you store employee files, contracts, and policy acknowledgements?
4. Do you run a formal annual performance cycle? What weighting do you use for business vs behavioural goals?
5. How do candidates apply — email CVs, LinkedIn only, or an ATS?
6. Who needs executive dashboards vs operational HR access?
7. Is SSO mandatory for procurement? When do you need expense or payroll in scope?
8. What audit or compliance frameworks apply (policy acks, Col, training records)?

Objection handling

Objection	Response
"We already use Excel for leave."	Excel cannot enforce manager→HR approval order, notify managers, or prove who approved. Kastros HR gives balances, workflow, and audit trail without losing flexibility on per-employee overrides.
"Managers won't adopt another system."	Managers use the same employee login they already have — no new credentials. They only see approval items for direct reports in notifications and leave queues.
"We need payroll on day one."	Compensation is captured today on profiles with multi-currency and allowances; payroll UI is on roadmap with schema ready. Many clients run phase 1 HR ops and integrate payroll export in phase 2.
"Is this secure enough for HR data?"	Walk through Part B: Firebase Auth, JWT sessions, three-layer RBAC, CSP/HSTS headers, audit log, and file authorisation. Offer security questionnaire completion during enterprise

Objection	Response
	deals.
"We need SSO."	Acknowledge roadmap item; email/password via Firebase is production-ready now. For enterprise, discuss custom token / SAML timeline alongside contract.
"Implementation will disrupt HR."	Three-week phased plan: master data week 1, people week 2, operations week 3. Public training manual reduces helpdesk load from day one.

Appendix — Competitive positioning

Position Kastros HR for mid-market trading and corporate groups that need depth without enterprise ERP complexity.

Dimension	Spreadsheets + email	Generic global HRIS	Kastros HR
Time to value	Immediate but brittle	6–12 months common	3-week structured rollout
Multi-BU UAE + PK	Manual	Configurable at cost	Native BU + currency contexts
Manager approvals	Email chains	Often per-seat manager module	Reporting-line — no 4th login
Recruit → hire data	Re-key everything	ATS + HRIS integration project	Built-in apply portal + onboard prefill
Performance (PMDF)	Paper / Word	Generic goals module	80/20 weighted PMDF with phase lockdown
Training adoption	PDF email blasts	Separate LMS fee	20-module public manual included
Audit trail	None	Varies by tier	Built-in audit log module

ROI themes (qualitative — tailor with prospect numbers)

- **HR hours saved:** Eliminate re-keying applicant data at hire; bulk leave entitlements vs per-person spreadsheets.
- **Faster approvals:** In-app notifications reduce leave approval cycle from days to hours.
- **Compliance risk reduction:** Timestamped policy acks and Col registry vs unsigned paper folders.
- **Executive time:** CEO dashboard replaces weekly “send me headcount and pending leave” requests.
- **Recruiting quality:** Structured applications with attachments beat unstructured email CVs.
- **Manager licensing:** No per-manager seat fee — reporting-line model scales with org depth.

Tip for AE: Quantify one workflow in the discovery call (e.g. “How many leave emails per week × 5 minutes”) and attach a conservative savings estimate in the proposal appendix.

Appendix — Leave workflow reference

Accurate status model for sales and implementation teams:

Status	Meaning	Who acts next
Pending Manager	Employee submitted; awaiting line manager	Manager on Reports to email (Employee login)
Pending HR	Manager approved; awaiting HR final	HR Admin or CEO
Approved	Fully approved	—
Denied	Rejected at manager or HR step	Employee may submit new request

If no line manager is set on the employee profile, HR receives the request directly for final approval — configure manager emails during onboarding to enable the two-step chain.

Entitlement model

1. HR defines leave *types* and default *days per year* in Settings.
2. HR applies defaults to all employees for the calendar year (bulk operation).
3. HR overrides individual balances on Leave module (e.g. seniority, carry-forward agreements).
4. Employee sees balances on My leave before submitting.

PMDF phase reference

HR sets open and deadline dates per phase. Fields outside the active window are locked for the relevant role.

Phase	Typical actor	Content focus
Objective Setting (Employee)	Employee	Business objectives (100% weight total); development pillars auto-weighted
Objective Setting (Manager)	Line manager	Review and align objectives
Mid Year Review (Employee / Manager)	Employee then manager	Progress comments, mid-year scores
Year End Evaluation (Employee / Manager)	Employee then manager	Final self and manager scores
Calibration	HR / leadership	Cross-team consistency
Finalization	HR	Lock final ratings
Closed	—	Read-only record; printable evaluation

Overall score: Business objectives final rating × 80% + Development objectives final rating × 20% = PMDP overall score. Rating bands map to HR actions (e.g. Below Expectations → PIP consideration).

Recruit → onboard data mapping

When HR clicks **Onboard** on an approved application, the following prefills into Add team member:

- Name, father name, email, personal and company phone
- Emergency contact name, relation, phone

- Family / COI declaration fields from application
- Role title (from application or job posting), location, employment type, probation months
- Reports to email if captured on application

HR still completes: department, sub-department, business unit, joining date, and internal employment details.
Education file attachments from the portal are not auto-copied — HR re-attaches on profile if required.

Appendix — FAQ for prospects

Do employees need a separate mobile app?

The platform is responsive in the browser on desktop and tablet today. Native mobile apps are on the roadmap; no app store install is required for go-live.

Can we hide expense claims until we are ready?

Yes. Expense modules are controlled by `KASTROS_EXPENSES_ENABLED` environment flag (default false). Manual modules hide expense content when disabled.

How many user roles exist?

Three login roles: Employee, HR Admin, CEO. Managers are not a separate product role — they are employees with direct reports who gain approval actions via the Reports to relationship.

Can the CEO approve leave?

Yes. CEO shares HR final approval permissions (Pending HR step) but cannot approve their own leave requests.

Is the training manual really public?

Yes. `/training-manual/how-to` requires no login — ideal for pre-go-live comms and in-app help links.

Where are files stored?

Firebase Storage in production (local fallback in development). Downloads require authorisation checks tied to the owning record.

Can we operate UAE and Pakistan in one tenant?

Yes. Business units (UAE, Karachi, Multan) with AED/PKR/USD on compensation support multi-country operations in one deployment.

What happens when someone changes role?

CEO updates role in User roles; Firebase custom claims update; user must sign out and back in for new permissions.

Do you support probation tracking?

Employee dashboard and CEO/HR dashboards surface probation end dates; alerts when within 10 days of probation completion.

Can we export data?

Firestore export via GCP tooling; profile and operational data accessible for integration. Formal customer export packages available during implementation.

How is this different from the management product overview?

This sales playbook is prospect-facing with screenshots, demo script, objection handling, and implementation phases. The executive product overview is an internal management briefing.

Appendix — Glossary

Term	Definition
BU	Business unit — e.g. UAE, Karachi, Multan operating entities
Col	Conflict of Interest — template upload and signed employee submissions
PMDF / PMDP	Performance Management & Development Form / Programme — annual review methodology
RBAC	Role-based access control — Employee, HR Admin, CEO
Reporting line	Manager relationship via Reports to email on employee profile
Entitlement	Allocated leave days per type per employee per year
Pending Manager / Pending HR	Leave approval workflow stages
Firebase Auth	Google identity service for work email authentication
Firestore	Document database for HR operational data in production
JWT session	Signed cookie carrying user identity and role after login
Feature flag	Environment variable toggling optional modules (e.g. expenses)

Document control: Kastros HR Sales Playbook · Version July 2026 · Confidential sales material. Regenerate PDF after platform updates: `npm run docs:sales-pdf` (requires Puppeteer and captured screenshots in `docs/sales/screenshots/`).

Screens captured from demonstration environment. For a live walkthrough or tailored proposal, contact your Kastros HR representative.